B2 vocabulary list

Every key word from the ten stories, grouped by story. Cover one column and test yourself.

1. La carta sin sello (The Unstamped Letter)

el hallazgo	discovery, find
catalogar	to catalogue
la encuadernación	binding (of a book)
el destinatario	addressee, recipient
el remitente	sender
el reglamento	regulations, rulebook
rasgar	to tear open
la reliquia	relic
cobarde	cowardly; coward
conmovido	moved, touched
arreglárselas	to manage, get by
rastrear	to track down, trace
el padrón	census, municipal register
la esquela	obituary notice
reabrir	to reopen
despierto	alert, sharp
restituir	to restore, give back
infringir	to break (a rule), infringe

2. El horno del patio (The Oven in the Courtyard)

tambalearse	to wobble, totter
la excedencia	leave of absence
desconcertar	to unsettle, disconcert
chirriante	squeaky, creaking
el fogón	stove, hearth (traditional cooking fire)
la hija pródiga	prodigal daughter
el recelo	wariness, distrust
desencaminado	mistaken, off track
postrado	laid up, confined (by illness or injury)
el fracaso	failure

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Fiction: characters are invented; places and history are real.

tallar	to scrub (Mexico; Spain: fregar)
menospreciar	to look down on, belittle
encurtido	pickled
afinar	to fine-tune, refine
el acierto	good move, stroke of insight
pasar inadvertido	to go unnoticed
la carcajada	hearty laugh
hacer las paces	to make peace

3. La mochila equivocada (The Wrong Backpack)

la apuesta	bet, wager
la Compostela	certificate given to pilgrims who complete the Camino
el bastón	walking pole, walking stick
el mojón	stone waymarker (with the distance to Santiago)
cojear	to limp
el sello	stamp (ink stamp)
la credencial	pilgrim passport (stamped along the Camino)
el pulpo a feira	Galician-style octopus (boiled, with paprika and olive oil)
remendado	patched, mended
el hospitalero	host who runs a pilgrims' hostel (often a volunteer)
la concha de vieira	scallop shell
tembloroso	shaky, trembling
el expediente	case file, dossier
el jubileo	jubilee (special pardon granted in a Holy Year)
la penitencia	penance
el posadero	innkeeper
la cojera	limp
a todas luces	clearly, quite obviously
el incensario	censer, thurible
la nave	nave (main body of a church)

4. Una frase de más (One Sentence Too Many)

el plazo	deadline, time limit

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angustioso	distressing, agonizing
la cuerda floja	tightrope
toparse con	to come across, bump into
inocuo	harmless
el homólogo	counterpart
la coartada	alibi, pretext
suavizar	to soften
matizar	to add nuance, qualify
torpe	clumsy
demoledor	devastating, crushing
el rubor	blush, embarrassment
la aclaración	clarification
desarmar	to disarm
la nota al pie	footnote
disimular	to conceal, disguise
tachar de	to label as, dismiss as
ahorrar	to spare, save
el qué dirán	what people will say, gossip

5. Lo que nadie vio en Corrientes (What Nobody Saw on Corrientes)

la persiana	shop shutter (roller shutter)
la librería de viejo	second-hand bookshop
la vitrina	display case, glass cabinet
la dedicatoria	inscription, dedication (written in a book)
nena	sweetheart, dear (Arg., affectionate; lit. little girl)
el pibe	kid, young guy (Arg., colloquial)
el sótano	basement
dormitar	to doze
decís	you say (vos form; tú: dices)
el kiosco de diarios	newsstand, newspaper kiosk
chorrear	to drip, to stream
el cadete	delivery boy, errand runner (Arg.)
mirá	look (vos command; tú: mira)
el rompecabezas	jigsaw puzzle
empapado	soaked, drenched

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ensayar	to rehearse
el lomo	spine (of a book)
el termo	thermos (for mate water)
la plata	money (Lat. Am., colloquial)
el maletín	briefcase
desmentir	to deny, to refute

6. El reloj de las cuatro y diez (The Watch Stopped at Ten Past Four)

advertir	to warn; to notice, point out
achacoso	ailing, frail
testarudo	stubborn, headstrong
apegado	attached, devoted
desconcertar	to baffle, to disconcert
el desasosiego	unease, restlessness
abatido	downcast, dejected
el afán	eagerness, zeal
el esmero	great care
cobrar vida	to come to life
estremecerse	to shudder
el umbral	threshold
descompuesto	broken down (Mexico)
la maceta	flowerpot
el resguardo	claim slip, receipt
latir	to beat, to tick
corregir	to correct
en vela	awake, sleepless
la terquedad	obstinacy
el áncora	pallet fork (watch escapement part; lit. anchor)

7. Lo de siempre (The Usual)

la fonda	small family restaurant, eatery
el comal	flat griddle (for tortillas and toasting chiles)
la antepasada	(female) ancestor
el metate	grinding stone (traditional Mexican)
espeso	thick (of a liquid)
la cazuela	clay cooking pot

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derrotar	to defeat
dirigirse la palabra	to speak to each other, be on speaking terms
el guajolote	turkey (Mexico)
el ajonjolí	sesame seeds
la prueba a ciegas	blind tasting, blind test
la talavera	talavera (hand-painted glazed pottery and tiles)
la capa	layer
decepcionar	to disappoint
el molino	mill (here: a shop that grinds chiles, corn, etc.)
el costal	sack (Mexico)
el delantal	apron
soltar una carcajada	to burst out laughing
enmarcar	to frame

8. La segunda parte del juramento (The Second Half of the Oath)

ensayar	to rehearse
dar la espalda	to turn one's back on
el juramento	oath, vow
tibio	lukewarm, noncommittal
el mirador	lookout, viewpoint
las canas	gray hairs
la falta de tacto	tactlessness
echar	to throw out, to expel
la maqueta	demo recording
cortar por lo sano	to make a clean break
el recado	message (left for someone)
reseco	dried out, brittle
el descuido	carelessness, oversight
el alivio	relief
la vergüenza	shame, embarrassment
el chirrido	creak, squeak
acoger	to receive, to welcome
brindar	to toast

9. Sin novedad en la sala siete (All Quiet in Room Seven)

crujir	to creak

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desperezarse	to stretch (oneself) awake
quebradizo	brittle, fragile
entrecortarse	to break off, to falter
cesar	to cease, to stop
la garita	guard booth
fantasioso	overimaginative
montar guardia	to stand watch
el chasquido	click, snap
el delantal	apron
la manivela	crank, handle
brotar	to spring forth, to pour out
tambalearse	to wobble, to totter
tararear	to hum
la errata	misprint, typo
respaldar	to back, to support
la jubilación	retirement
el plato fuerte	main attraction, highlight

10. Capitolio, 1938 (Capitolio, 1938)

el reverso	back (of a photo or page)
la escalinata	flight of (outdoor) steps
los lunares	polka dots
la cúpula	dome
el buchito	small cup of coffee (Cuba)
la lupa	magnifying glass
la máquina	car (Cuba); machine
la aleta	tail fin (of a car)
el almendrón	classic 1950s American car (Cuba)
la guagua	bus (Cuba, Caribbean)
el puesto	stall
el minutero	street photographer with a box camera (Cuba)
el trípode	tripod
revelar	to develop (photos)
la cifra	digit, figure
despistado	absent-minded, scatterbrained

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la humedad	damp, humidity
los espejuelos	glasses, spectacles (Cuba)
el recibo	receipt

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